



Tencent's games merger blocked

Tencent's \$5.3 billion video games merger gets blocked by Chinese antitrust regulator. <https://digit.in/jul21-97>



Bye bye Mix and Fix

Adobe removes "Photoshop Mix" and "Photoshop Fix" from App Store. <https://digit.in/jul21-98>

Linksys E8450 AX3200 Wi-Fi 6 Router

A great starter Wi-Fi 6 router

While Wi-Fi 6 devices have been in the market for a while, they're all selling for a slight price premium given that these are using the latest wireless protocol. There's a good market for Wi-Fi 6 routers which not only provide users access to the latest Wi-Fi 6 protocol but they're also economical at the same time. The Linksys E8450 AX3200 router is one such device, albeit it's on the pricier end of the spectrum.

FEATURES

The Linksys E8450 Wi-Fi 6 router has a cumulative bandwidth of 3200 Mbps which is quite a lot for a router in this day and age. The bandwidth is broken across the two bands – 2.4 GHz (800 Mbps) and 5 GHz (2400 Mbps). The latest firmware even adds support for EasyMesh which is the standard released by the Wi-Fi alliance. It helps in situations where multiple access points from different vendors exist. EasyMesh makes it easy for these different devices to talk to each other and form a unified mesh network. EasyMesh helps direct client devices to the nearest or rather most appropriate access point in a mesh network. This is very similar to the mesh capabilities of many premium mesh routers, so getting the same in a mid-range router is a good bargain.

The other part is the supported channels on the 5 GHz band. One of the benefits of Wi-Fi 6 is that you get a fatter 160 MHz channel for devices that are more bandwidth heavy. The Linksys E8450 does not have support for the 160 MHz channel or even the 80 MHz channel. This is quite odd given that one of the important aspects of labelling a router as Wi-Fi 6 is adherence to the complete standard. This is a feature that would be appreciated by



Price
₹13,999



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power users and a ₹14K wireless router falls right in the enthusiast / power-user territory. Another gripe we have with the Linksys E8450 is that it uses a USB 2.0 port rather

than a USB 3.0 port. External hard drives have a bandwidth of around 115 MBps and USB 2.0 peaks at a little less than 50% of the bandwidth so it's really dated. Also, there's no mention of OFDMA on the spec sheet but it's quite possible that it has been implemented. However, most routers in the market don't have OFDMA support, so we can look this aspect over.

BUILD QUALITY

There's no concern about the build quality since Linksys has maintained a good standard of construction for quite some time. There's a single main PCB on the inside with a beefy heatsink on one side to handle the thermals of the SoC. Additionally, there are two smaller antennas at the top of the router. So it's best to keep the router upright and not have it lie on its side.

The SoC running this machine is the MediaTek MT7622BV which is a highly integrated 4x4 solution. It

has a dual-core CPU with Cortex-A53 cores clocked at 1.35 GHz so there's no dearth of processing power either. For the memory, it's using a Winbond W634GG6NB DDR3 512 MB chip. Additionally, it uses a MediaTek MT7531BE network switch.

Lastly, the LED indicators are situated on the front in a vertical array.

PERFORMANCE

The inter LAN speeds were pretty good and peaked at 918 Mbps. We used a laptop with an Intel AX200 Wi-Fi 6 card to test the speeds out. Unfortunately, the AX200 is a 2T2R card with support for 160 MHz and the Linksys E8450 does not support the 160 MHz channel. So we ended up scoring 865 MBps with the units close to each other and it dropped to about 593 MBps as the clients were moved further apart. On the 2.4 GHz band we scored about 81 MBps with the clients right next to each other and when placed apart the speeds dropped to 57 MBps. For something that costs about ₹14K, these are good numbers. Obviously, a 160 MHz channel would have pushed these numbers higher but this is fine considering the price point.

VERDICT

The Linksys E8450 is a pretty good wireless router. The lack of the 160 MHz channel and USB 3.0 can be irksome for some enthusiasts, but for the vast majority of users, this is totally fine and makes for a great router. The recent addition of EasyMesh is the cherry on top.

—Mithun Mohandas

SPECIFICATIONS

MODEL: E8450 | WI-FI: 802.11ax | LAN: 4x 10/100/1000 Gbit | WAN: 10/100/1000 Gbit | USB: 2.0 Port | SOC: MediaTek MT7622BV | WLAN: QCA8075 | DIMENSIONS: 114 x 114 x 244 cms | WEIGHT: 1.6 kg | WARRANTY: 3 - years.

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